

1.8 GB of data.

The UMD did not take off despite it being bundled with the PSP and the format has since been abandoned by Sony on the latest model of the handheld console, the PSP GO.

The lack of copy-protection options on the UMD disks was also seen as one of the major reasons that piracy was rampant on the PlayStation Portable.

Storage

For the PlayStation Portable, storage is completely restricted to memory cards. Since it is a Sony device, the company obviously threw in a slot only for its proprietary Memory Stick Duo cards. Users can also use Memory Stick Micro cards with a Duo adaptor.

While older versions of the PSP supported no more than 4 GB cards, the latest version (PSP-3000) along with the latest update claims to be able to support cards of up to 16 GB in size.

While doing away with the UMD drive, the upcoming PSP GO is expected to pack 8-16 GB of onboard flash memory. This is being seen as a sign that Sony is going into online retail distribution for further video game sales on the PSP.

Connectivity

The PlayStation Portable is equipped with a Wi-Fi chip that allows it to connect to any live connection. More importantly, this enables the PSP to form WLAN connections with other PSPs in the vicinity for multiplayer gameplay.

This allows 2-16 players with PSPs to create a local, ad hoc network for multiplayer gameplay; or send images from one PSP to another by use of the 'send' and 'receive' functions that appear in the 'PHOTO' menu; or even connect to a PlayStation 3 via Remote Play.

Currently, no version of the PSP is equipped with Bluetooth technology.

The PSP also features ports for TV out and a standard 3.5 mm audio jack to connect your favourite headphones.

Battery

The PSP's default battery life varies widely depending on application from less than three hours while accessing a wireless network and having screen brightness on its highest setting, to more than 11 hours during MP3 playback with the screen turned off. An extended-life 2200 mAh battery will increase this by approximately 20 per cent.

A sleep mode is also available that uses minimal battery power to keep the system's RAM active, allowing for 'instant on' functionality. A system in sleep mode (with a fully-charged battery) has been shown to lose an average of only 1 per cent battery life per 24-hour period.